

Ritik Varaganti

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Education

Dougherty Valley High School

3.94/4.00 | 4.46/5.00 (UW/W) GPA

2023 - 2027

Relevant Coursework: AP Computer Science Principles, AP Calculus AB, AP Computer Science A, Honors Physics, Honors Precalculus, Honors Chemistry

San Ramon, California

Diablo Valley College

4.00/4.00 GPA

Relevant Coursework: Calculus I, Computer Science I

Experience

Research Intern @ University of North Carolina, QIAI Lab

Ongoing

- Compiled and cleaned 200+ GB of Mechanical Engineering textual data from arXiv, Google Scholar, etc. totaling over 50,000 research papers
- Trained Facebook's LLaMA 4 model in collaboration with UNC Mechanical Engineering department, paper incoming

Research Intern @ University of California at San Diego, Ujima S&P Lab

- Utilizing Natural Language Processing Techniques to analyze generated AI content on short-form video platforms

Projects/Publications

Behavioral and Emotional Analysis for Comprehensive Observation and

2025

Diagnosing for Accurate Early Detection and Intervention in Autism Spectrum Disorder (BEACOD)

- Research paper recognized as one of the best in state, hand-selected to present at San Francisco State University for the Northern California Junior Science and Health Symposium from the US Department of Defense
- Designed and built a multimodal Machine Learning model that is able to effectively diagnose ASD from an entirely behavioral approach (combines data from facial micro-expressions, audio cues, verbal responses)
- Used techniques like Optical Flow (Lucas-Kanade method), K-means, etc, developed custom-built Transformer and CNN based models on audio, video, and speech data from ASD individuals

ISIC Skin Cancer Detection with 3D-TBP

2024

- Devised ensemble model of XGBoost, CatBoost, LGBM run on text based data + Convolutional Neural Network run on image based data
- Used techniques like ensembling models, One Hot Encoding, advanced data analysis (multicollinearity, feature engineering, variable correlations, etc.), voting classifiers, and more
- Achieved scores within top 2% of 13,000+ participants, achieving partial area under the ROC curve (pAUC) score of 0.1853

Awards

YSIC Youth International Investing Competition

June, 2024

- Scored in top 10 in 600+ participating teams as graded by 4 Wall Street executives
- Scraped and compiled stock data, ran algorithms (LSTM, BiLSTM, etc.) on metrics like Stochastic Oscillator, RSI to determine optimal stocks, analyzed stock data w/ time series decomposition

RSNA 2024 Lumbar Spine Classification

October, 2024

- Scored within top 6% in 15,000+ participants
- Developed convolutional neural network to classify condition based on spine photographs

American Math Competition (AMC)

November, 2023

- Scored within top 1% of test-takers in the United States in the first stage of the American Mathematics Competition
- Achieved Distinguished Honor Roll status (21/25 questions correct)

Presidential Volunteer Service Award - Gold

July, 2024

- Partnered with local nonprofit to assemble and distribute 15+ efficient NAS data systems for 75+ hours
- Worked as assistant to Autism Paraeducator at local elementary school, taught and cared for children with Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) for 80+ hours

Additional

Languages: Python, Java, HTML/CSS, JavaScript

Frameworks: PyTorch, Keras, TensorFlow, SciKit-Learn, Hugging Face Transformers, Torchvision, TorchAudio

Libraries: Seaborn, matplotlib, LightGBM, XGBoost, CatBoost, Optuna, pandas, NumPy, OpenCV, SciPy, yt-dlp, Librosa